

SOC Alert Triage Casebook

Completed simulated tickets showing evidence review, disposition, containment, and Tier 2 handoff

SOC-2026-101 - Brute Force Followed by Successful Login

Field	Value
Severity	High
Affected scope	j.smith / 203.0.113.44
Summary	14 failed logins in ~4 minutes followed by one password-only success from the same source.
Disposition	True Positive - Escalated
ATT&CK; / rationale	T1110 - Brute Force; escalate because compromise is plausible after a success.

Evidence Reviewed

- Authentication log search for user and source IP
- MFA/authentication method history
- Device history
- Related-account search from source IP

Analyst Findings

- Source was not a normal internal address.
- Successful login followed the failure burst.
- Login used password rather than MFA.
- No other internal user showed a successful login from this source.

Containment / Handoff

Revoke active session, reset credentials, require MFA, block source where appropriate, and review post-login activity.

SOC-2026-102 - Password Spraying Across Multiple Accounts

Field	Value
Severity	High
Affected scope	5 users / 198.51.100.33
Summary	One external source attempted authentication against five users in a short window with low attempts per user.
Disposition	True Positive - Contained
ATT&CK; / rationale	T1110.003 - Password Spraying; no success reduced immediate impact but the pattern is malicious.

Evidence Reviewed

- Distinct-user count by source
- Success correlation
- Known scanner/VPN allowlist
- Targeted account privilege review

Analyst Findings

- Five unique users were targeted.
- Pattern avoided high per-user failure counts.
- No successful login occurred in the reviewed window.
- Source was not on approved testing list.

Containment / Handoff

Block source in the simulated case, notify identity/security team, monitor targeted users, and verify MFA coverage.

SOC-2026-103 - Impossible Travel Login

Field	Value
Severity	High
Affected scope	m.turner
Summary	Successful login from US-NC followed 32 minutes later by password-only success from DE-BE using an unknown device.
Disposition	True Positive - Escalated
ATT&CK; / rationale	Valid-account compromise suspected; geography alone is not enough, but device and auth-method evidence increased confidence.

Evidence Reviewed

- Prior successful logins
- VPN/corporate egress inventory
- Device history
- MFA events
- Post-login activity

Analyst Findings

- First login matched known workstation and MFA.
- Second login used an unknown device and password-only authentication.
- No approved VPN path explained the geography.
- Timing was inconsistent with physical travel.

Containment / Handoff

Revoke session, reset credentials, force MFA re-registration if needed, and review mailbox/cloud activity.

SOC-2026-104 - Suspicious PowerShell from Office Process

Field	Value
Severity	High
Affected scope	WS-117 / j.smith
Summary	Word process spawned PowerShell with encoded command pattern and outbound network activity.
Disposition	True Positive - Escalated
ATT&CK; / rationale	T1566.001 + T1059.001 supported by the simulated process chain.

Evidence Reviewed

- EDR process tree
- Command line
- Parent/child process chain
- Network connections
- Persistence search

Analyst Findings

- Office-to-PowerShell chain was unusual.
- Encoded command behavior matched lab detection.
- Outbound connection followed execution.
- Scheduled-task evidence appeared shortly afterward in the simulated endpoint case.

Containment / Handoff

Isolate host, preserve evidence, disable affected sessions, block indicators, and hand off for endpoint IR.